Centre Punch



Category: **Measuring & Marking Tools** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 4 labs

Covers these lab items: Centre punch

What it is used for

To create a small indentation that guides a drill bit on a marked point. To improve drilling accuracy and reduce bit slipping.

Main parts

- Punch tip
- Steel body
- Striking head
- Marking point

Before you start

1. Mark the drilling location clearly.
2. Check the punch tip and striking head for damage.
3. Secure the workpiece on a stable surface.
4. Wear safety glasses.

How to use

1. Place the punch tip on the marked point.
2. Hold the punch upright and steady.
3. Strike the head gently with a suitable hammer.
4. Check the indentation and repeat with controlled force if needed.
5. Move the punch away before drilling.

⚠ Safety

- Keep fingers clear of the hammer striking area.
- Do not use a cracked or mushroomed punch head.
- Secure small workpieces before striking.
- Wear eye protection against flying metal fragments.

Care & storage

- Wipe the punch clean after use.
- Inspect the tip and head regularly.
- Store with other marking tools in a dry place.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Holding the punch at an angle.
- Striking too hard and damaging the workpiece.
- Using a damaged punch.
- Failing to secure the workpiece.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

Prepared by - Subodh Kumar